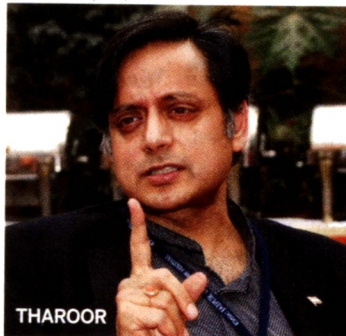


DELHI | Twittering Minister

First-time MP and Minister of State Shashi Tharoor is engaging in a new pursuit. He is busy recording his meandering through the political labyrinth on Twitter, the micro-blog networking site that you would have to be vacationing on the moon to not know about. Tharoor records all trivia: "e-mails have not yet replaced files in the ministry. Tied with strings too". Or meet Michael Jackson who "pretended" that he had read the minister's *Show Business* and, as Tharoor says, was lobbying to be the UN goodwill ambas-

PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR



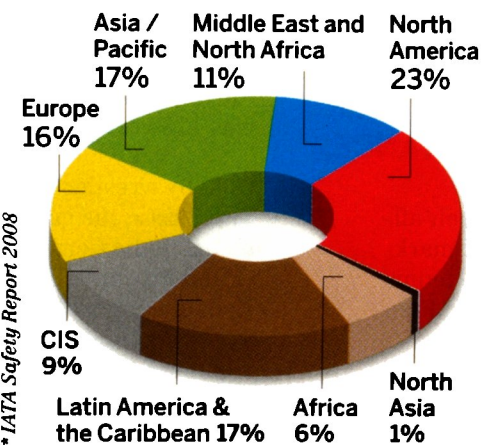
sador. The Tharoor twittering has acquired global fame. At a recent lunch in Dubai, the host foreign trade minister Sheika Lubna introduced him as the Twitter Minister. *by Priya Sahgal*

AHMEDABAD | Given Up

The BJP's "Mr Embarrassment" is now behind bars. After dodging the police for two months, the BJP MLA from Rajgad, Fatehsinh Chauhan, surrendered after failing to get anticipatory bail. He was accused of leading mobs against Muslims in 21 villages during the 2002 Gujarat riots. Chauhan evaded arrest by disguising himself and even cast his vote in the Lok Sabha polls posing as a tribal. He also lashed out at Sonia Gandhi at an election meeting while he was on the run. *by Uday Mahurkar*

THAROOR'S TWITTERINGS COVER A VAST SWEEP: FROM THE STRINGS THAT TIE MINISTRY FILES TO HIS MEETING WITH THE NOW LATE MICHAEL JACKSON.

Regional break-up of accidents in 2008



DELHI | Crash Landing

In 2008, there were 109 aircraft accidents, in other words, approximately one every four days. The International Air Transport Association in its Safety Report says of these, around 71 were related to passenger aircraft. Maximum accidents (25 per cent) were due to runway excursions, followed by ground damage (17 per cent) and loss of control in-flight (13 per cent). The least number (2 per cent) was due to runway collisions and the majority of mishaps (47 per cent) took place while landing. *by Nandini Valsh*

MAOISTS AND THE TRINAMOOL ARE USING BANNERS TO MAKE VASTLY OPPOSING POINTS.

KOLKATA | Off the Wall

In West Bengal's permanently heated political arena, posters seem to be mightier than the verbal war. Reminiscent of the 1970s when the Naxals drove terror into Kolkata, Maoist posters have made a comeback in the landmark India Coffee House on College Street, once the hub of the extreme leftists. Well right of Naxal thought, the Dum Dum unit for the Trinamool Congress found a novel way of campaigning against the CPI(M) in the recently held municipal polls—the enigmatic poster. Banners in the area merely say, "The CPI(M) did not allow you to vote in 2004. Will they allow us this time to do so? But I have decided that this time, I will vote for whom I wish. I hope you will too." The posters are signed by Vivek, in translation Conscience, and do not even mention the Trinamool Congress. *by Abhijit Dasgupta*

